

Desktop Storage/Backup Drives

Seagate	Seagate	Seagate	Western Digital	Western Digital	Maxtor	Maxtor
100 GB ST9100801U2-RK	160 GB with Firewire	400 GB Barracuda	WD2500B011 RNN	250 Media Center	300GB One Touch II	One Touch 250GB
13.25	8.24	9.99	8.68	10.18	11.01	7.73
127x99x25.4	180.9x165.5x57	180.9x165.5x57	230x150x50	230x150x50	210x120x4	210x120x4
100.00	1050.00	1176.50	1360.00	1360.00	1380.00	1380.00
2.50	3.50	3.50	3.50	3.50	3.50	3.50
100	160	400	250	250	300	250
5400	7200	7200	7200	7200	7200	5400
8	8	8	8	8	16	2
USB 2.0	USB 2.0/Firewire	USB 2.0/Firewire	USB 2.0/Firewire	USB 2.0/Firewire	USB 2.0/Firewire	USB 2.0/Firewire
Blue LED	Yellow LED	2 Blue LEDs	Blue LED	Blue LED	Blue LED	Blue LED
None	Single Power/Backup Button	One Touch backup	Power, Auto backup, and On Demand Backup	Power, Auto backup, and On Demand Backup	power button single press is backup	power button single press is backup
USB 2.0	Power Adapter	Power Adapter	Power Adapter	Power Adapter	Power Adapter	Power Adapter
None	None	None	None	MMC card reader!	None	None
4.25	4.00	4.00	3.50	3.50	4.00	4.00
4.00	3.25	3.25	3.50	3.50	2.75	2.75
Seaget utilities	Backup	Backup	Backup	Backup	Backup	Backup
✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
USB Cable	USB/Firewire cable/Power adapter/stand	USB/Firewire cable/Power adapter/stand	USB/Firewire cable/Power adapter/stand	USB/Firewire cable/Power adapter/stand	USB/Firewire cable/Power adapter/stand	USB/Firewire cable/Power adapter/stand
✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
50.14	33.61	46.89	44.24	40.96	49.77	33.73
28	24	35	29	24	35	22
34	28	41	29	24	41	25
23	20	31	29	25	26	21
25	20	28	27	21	31	19
25	18	28	27	21	31	19
14	15	8	9	2	14	9
3.75	3.96	3.87	3.96	3.89	3.79	3.74
47.02	56.91	41.90	43.65	54.46	34.20	58.26
52.66	62.28	46.63	44.98	58.08	42.24	57.50
31.89	39.15	39.42	31.16	37.36	26.99	48.71
40.26	54.79	33.88	34.93	45.90	31.54	48.73
17.00	5.49	8.57	7.16	8.55	10.05	8.95
93.00	149	372.00	233	232	300.00	233
13000	12500	20000	15000	12500	13750	12000
0.14	0.08	0.05	0.06	0.05	0.04	0.05
80.39	47.34	65.09	59.76	59.38	70.48	50.05

The painfully slow drive here was from Maxtor—the Maxtor 250 GB. No surprises, as the drive has a slow 5,400 rpm spindle speed coupled with a devastatingly low cache (a mere 2 MB). There was no way this drive was competing for anything with anybody. The rest were simply out of its league.

The other drive that was impressive and really kept a consistent performance was the Seagate 400 GB Barracuda. Although it can't be compared to the One Touch II, it was commendably fast, and its value-for-money proposition is simply to die for! A massive 400 GB for a mere Rs 20,000!

The fact that the Seagate 400 GB scored some pretty impressive numbers is not to say that it was second only to the One Touch II. In

fact, the WD 250 GB drive beat the Seagate 400 GB in every real-world test, and was slower only in the sequential write test.

So if massive storage is not what you are looking for, and if you are a WD fan, this one is a pretty good buy.



Seagate 400 GB Barracuda



Mr Spacious: The drive that eventually won had everything going for it: price, performance and some pretty decent features. The Best Buy Gold goes to the Maxtor One Touch II 300 GB. This is an excellent backup solution as it is affordable, performs like a dream, and features a huge 300 GB of space.

The Seagate Barracuda 400 GB comprehensively beat the rest of the competition, and though the price tag might seem a shocker, the fact is that no other drive or drive manufacturer out there gives you a 400 GB hard disk drive. Cost per MB, though not the lowest, is certainly competitive—so we adjudge it our Best Buy Silver award winner. ☐

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